

Day 9 — Project Session: Build the Herb Deck

Module: Auṣadhi · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, each pair has produced **all six cards** in draft form, each containing the eight required elements (see below). The cards are ready for finalising at home and presenting on Day 10.

Materials

- Pre-cut A6 (or quarter-A4) cards — 6 per pair, plus 2 spares
- Colour pencils, fine-tip markers, scale rulers
- Reference: students’ Day 2–8 worksheets (instruct them to bring these)
- Project brief ([assessments/project-brief.md](#)) printed and visible
- Rubric ([assessments/rubric.md](#)) printed and visible

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Read the project brief aloud (one student volunteers).

Restate the **eight required elements** on each card: 1. Sketch of the herb (leaf, root, or seed — whichever is most identifying) 2. **Sanskrit name** in IAST 3. **English / common name** 4. **Botanical name** (italicised) 5. **Family** (e.g. Lamiaceae, Apiaceae, Zingiberaceae) 6. **Three identifying features** (smell, leaf shape, colour, etc.) 7. **Active compound** (curcumin, eugenol, etc.) 8. **One traditional use + one safety note**

Show one finished card example (you can use yesterday’s *pudīnā* card-template).

Core / activity (35 min)

Pairs work continuously. The teacher rotates and intervenes.

Pacing checkpoints — write on the board:

- **By minute 12 (out of 35):** All six cards should have the sketch + Sanskrit + English name. (The fastest part.)
- **By minute 25:** All six cards should have the active compound and one traditional use.
- **By minute 35:** Each card should have the safety note + three identifying features.

If a pair lags at any checkpoint, intervene specifically — don’t let them spend 15 minutes perfecting one card.

Quality interventions to watch for: - Cards copying directly from a worksheet without engagement → ask “what’s the most interesting thing about this herb? Add that to the card.” -

Cards with no safety note → “what’s the dose question for this herb?” Write the answer. - Cards with grand health claims (“turmeric cures arthritis”) → push back: “what does the evidence actually say?” - Cards missing the family → look it up together on the board (Lamiaceae for tulsi+mint, Apiaceae for ajwain, Zingiberaceae for ginger+turmeric, Meliaceae for neem).

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Each pair holds up one card they’re proudest of. 10-second show + tell.
- Collect cards in pair-folders for tomorrow. (Or have pairs take them home if they prefer to finalise overnight.)
- Hand out the reflection slip — to complete tonight as homework: > “*What I set out to learn, what I actually learned, and one question I still have.*”

Student-facing content

Today: build your 6-card herb deck.

Each card has eight things — sketch, Sanskrit name, English name, botanical name, family, three identifying features, active compound, and one traditional use + one safety note.

Quality over completeness — but all six cards must be drafted by end of class.

Use what you’ve already drawn and noted across Days 2–7. Your worksheets are your raw material; the cards are the polished version.

Homework

- Finalise any card you didn’t complete in class.
- Complete the reflection slip.
- Bring all six cards + reflection slip + pencils to Day 10.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Make a **7th card** for a herb of your choice — *aśvagandhā*, *brāhmī*, *triphalā*, *kariveppilai* (curry leaf), or *dhānyaka* (coriander). Apply the same eight-element template.
- **One tier down:** Make 4 cards (drop turmeric and ajwain if compressed) — but each must have all 8 elements. Quality over quantity.

Teacher notes

- This is a build session, not a teaching session. Resist the urge to lecture. Walk around. Ask questions. Point at gaps.
- Common failure mode: pairs spend the first 15 min discussing what to draw and end up with one half-card. Set the timer visible. Push pace.
- Common failure mode: one partner draws while the other watches. Reassign — partner A does 3 cards in pen, partner B does 3 cards in pen, then they swap and refine each other’s.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- Project brief — assessments/project-brief.md

- Rubric — [assessments/rubric.md](#)